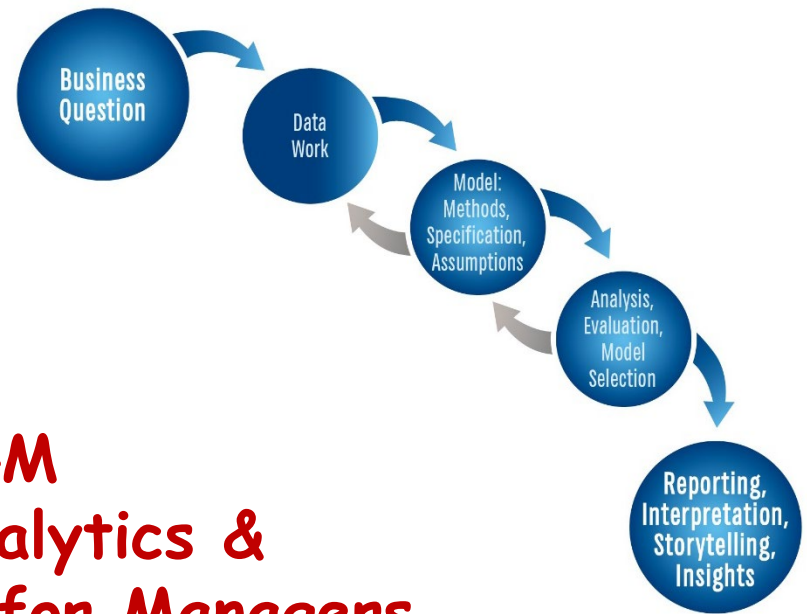




PAML4M
**Predictive Analytics &
Machine Learning for Managers**

9. Classification Models

Use PAML4M_9R_ClassificationModels.Qmd

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Last updated 8/1/2026



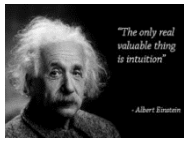
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Analytics Modeling Options

	Modeling Method		
	Structured	Visual, Text, Unstructured, etc.	
Descriptive	Cluster analysis, correlation, market basket analysis, sample statistics, ANOVA		Bubble charts, network diagrams, natural language processing, clustering dendograms, etc.
Predictive	Association	Decision Tree	Charts
Quantitative Value	Regression	Regression Trees	Regression plots, scatter plots, Tableau diagrams, trend charts, etc.
Classification	Logistic Regression; Other Categorical Regression Models	Classification Trees	Tree maps, interactive diagrams,
Prescriptive	Operations research, decision modeling, optimization, linear programming		Simulations, etc.

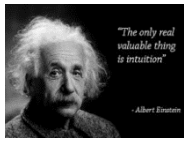
Introduction to Classification Models

$YC(x)$ - Y is not continuous, but categorical



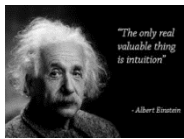
Classification Models: Intuition

- A classification model is one in which the **outcome** variable is **categorical**, and the model aims at predicting the **category** or class of an outcome, based on the **likelihood** that the outcome falls in that **category**.
- **Examples:** is an e-mail message spam or legitimate? is a loan customer likely to default or not? is a given purchase transaction fraudulent or not? how would you predict who will make an A in the class?
- Popular **modeling methods** for classification include:
 - **Logistic Regression** – Binomial and Multinomial
 - **Linear & Quadratic Discriminant Analysis (FYI)**
 - **Classification Tree Models** (next week)
 - **Neural Networks** (final week)
 - K Nearest Neighbors (not covered)
 - Support Vector Machines (not covered)



Binomial vs. Multinomial Categorical Outcomes

- Some **categories** are **ordinal** – e.g., freshman, sophomore, etc.
- Some are unordered → **categorical** – e.g., rural, suburban, urban
- We need to transform **categories to quantitative** values to fit regression models
- If the outcome variable is **binomial** – i.e., it has two possible outcomes, so it can be easily quantified with **dummy variables** (e.g., **0** = no loan default; **1** = loan default)
- If the outcome is **multinomial** – i.e., has $k > 2$ possible outcomes (e.g., stroke, heart attack, no illness)
 - It is more difficult to **quantify categorical outcomes**
 - We need to **transform** convert **categorical to binary** variables



Binomial Classification and MLE

- **Maximum Likelihood Estimation (MLE)** is a popular estimation method for **binomial classification**
- For **2 independent** observations **A** and **B**, the probability of both happening is: $P(A \& B) = P(A) * P(B)$
- So, if an outcome variable can take a value of **0** or **1**, the probability of all observations x_i being **classified correctly** is equal to the **product** of the **probability** of **each** observation being classified correctly, either as **1** or as **0**:

$$\text{Likelihood}(\beta_0, \beta_1) = \prod_{\substack{i: y_i=1 \\ \text{All positives}}} p(\hat{y}_i | x_i = 1) \prod_{\substack{i: y_i=0 \\ \text{All negatives}}} \overbrace{(1 - p(\hat{y}_i | x_i = 1))}^{p(\hat{y}_i | x_i = 0)}$$

- The **MLE** method computes this likelihood for several values of β_0 and β_1 using **algorithms** and selects the ones where the likelihood of a correct classification is the **largest**

Binomial Logistic Models

More on Interpretation

For a model: $\text{Logit}(Y) = \beta_0 + \beta_1(X_1) + \beta_2(X_2) + \dots + \varepsilon$

- **Y is a binary variable** (e.g., Non-Smoker = 0; Smoker = 1)
 β_0 is the **log-odds** of $Y = 1$ when $X_1 = X_2 = 0$ (just born, male → smokes)
 e^{β_0} is the **odds** of $Y = 1$ when $X_1 = X_2 = 0$ (just born, male → smokes)
- **If X_1 is a binary variable** (e.g., Male = 0; Female = 1)
 $\beta_0 + \beta_1$ = **log-odds** of $Y = 1$ when $X_1 = 1$ and $X_2 = 0$ (just born, female → smokes)
 $e^{(\beta_0 + \beta_1)}$ = **odds** of $Y = 1$ when $X_1 = 1$ and $X_2 = 0$ (just born, female → smokes)
 β_1 = **change** in **log-odds** of $Y = 1$ (smokes) when $X_1 = 1$ (female, compared to male)
 e^{β_1} = how much the **odds** of $Y = 1$ **multiply** when $X_1 = 1$ (↑ if >1; ↓ if <1)
- **If X_2 is a continuous variable** (e.g., Age)
 β_2 is the **increase** in **log-odds** of $Y = 1$ when $X_2 \uparrow 1$ (age increases by 1)
 e^{β_2} is how much the **odds** of $Y = 1$ **multiply** when $X_2 \uparrow 1$ (↑ if >1; ↓ if <1)

Interpretation Pointers

- Log Odds (0) $\rightarrow$ Odds = 1 $\rightarrow$ Prob = 0.5
 $\rightarrow$ chance (flip a coin)
- If $\beta = 0$ (i.e., not significant) the predictor doesn't change the odds
- If Log Odds (-) $\rightarrow$ Odds < 1 $\rightarrow$ Prob < 0.5
 $\rightarrow$ (-) β in a logistic regression
 $\rightarrow$ The log odds go down
 $\rightarrow$ The odds change by less than 1 to 1
- If Log Odds (+) $\rightarrow$ Odds > 1 $\rightarrow$ Prob > 0.5
 $\rightarrow$ (+) β in a logistic regression
 $\rightarrow$ The log odds go up
 $\rightarrow$ The odds change by more than 1 to 1

Prob	Prob%	Odds	Log Odds
		$p/(1-p)$	$\ln(o)$
0.001	0.1%	0.001	-6.907
0.01	1%	0.010	-4.595
0.1	10%	0.111	-2.197
0.2	20%	0.250	-1.386
0.3	30%	0.429	-0.847
0.4	40%	0.667	-0.405
0.5	50%	1.000	0.000
0.6	60%	1.500	0.405
0.7	70%	2.333	0.847
0.8	80%	4.000	1.386
0.9	90%	9.000	2.197
1.0	100%		

Log Odds	Odds	Prob	Prob%
	$e^{(\text{Log Odds})}$	$o/(1+o)$	
-6.907	0.001	0.001	0%
-4.595	0.010	0.01	1%
-2.197	0.111	0.1	10%
-1.386	0.250	0.2	20%
-0.847	0.429	0.3	30%
-0.405	0.667	0.4	40%
0.000	1.000	0.5	50%
0.405	1.500	0.6	60%
0.847	2.333	0.7	70%
1.386	4.000	0.8	80%
2.197	9.000	0.9	90%
		1.0	100%



Binomial Logistic Regression

- {library} Topic
Search keywords
- Binomial Logistic Regression
`heart <- read.table("Heart.csv",`

The Confusion Matrix

Is a table that makes it easy to visualize if a model is “**confusing**” or **misclassifying** categorical predictions



Confusion Matrix: Classification Fit Statistics

$$\text{Error Rate} = \frac{\text{Incorrect}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{\text{FP} + \text{FN}}{T}$$

$$\text{Accuracy Rate} = \frac{\text{Correct}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{\text{TP} + \text{TN}}{T}$$

Accuracy predicting positives:

$$\text{Sensitivity} = \frac{\text{TP}}{P} = \frac{\text{TP}}{\text{TP} + \text{FN}}$$

Accuracy predicting negatives

$$\text{Specificity} = \frac{\text{TN}}{N} = \frac{\text{TN}}{\text{TN} + \text{FP}}$$

Error predicting positives (False Positives)

$$1 - \text{Specificity} = 1 - \frac{\text{TN}}{\text{TN} + \text{FP}} = \frac{\text{FP}}{N}$$

Predicted	Actual		Total
	No (0)	Yes (1)	
No (0)	^[1,1] TN	^[1,2] FN	N _{Pr}
Yes (1)	^[2,1] FP	^[2,2] TP	P _{Pr}
Total	N	P	T



Classification Threshold

- We generally use the threshold $\lambda = \text{Prob}(Y=1) > 0.5$ to predict a positive, and the opposite for a negative.
- But if we are more interested in either sensitivity or specificity, we can change this threshold to other values



Binomial Logit: Fit Statistics

- The `glm()` function in R reports two important fit statistics:
(1) **Deviance** or 2LL and (2) **AIC** $\rightarrow 2LL + 2n$ (n = number of predictors)
- Confusion Matrix** $\rightarrow$ A better way to evaluate classification models:

$$\text{Error Rate} = \frac{\text{Incorrect}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{457 + 141}{1,250} = 0.48 = 1 - \text{Accuracy Rate}$$

$$\text{Accuracy Rate} = \frac{\text{Correct}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{145 + 507}{1,250} = 0.52$$

$$\text{Sensitivity} = \frac{\text{True Positives}}{\text{All Positives}} = \frac{507}{648} = 0.78$$

$$\text{Specificity} = \frac{\text{True Negatives}}{\text{All Negatives}} = \frac{145}{602} = 0.24$$

Predicted	Actual		Total
	Down	Up	
Down	^[1,1] 145	^[1,2] 141	286
Up	^[2,1] 457	^[2,2] 507	964
Total	602	648	1,250

$$\text{False Positives} = 1 - \text{Specificity} = \frac{\text{False Positives}}{\text{All Negatives}} = \frac{457}{602} = 0.76$$

- The model above has almost the same **error rate** as flipping a coin (not good); it's very **imprecise** about predicting **negatives** (Down) but it does much **better** at predicting **positives** (Up)



Confusion Matrix

- {library} Topic
Search keywords
- The Confusion Matrix
`train <- sample(1:nrow(heart),`

Sensitivity, Specificity and ROC



Unbalanced Data

- In some data sets the outcome variable is **unbalanced**
- For example, when people get tested for Covid, maybe only **5%** are **positive**. This would mean that if we predict that everyone is negative without a model (i.e., **null model**), our success at predicting negatives (i.e., **specificity**) would be **95%**. But our **sensitivity** would be **0%** (i.e., no positive predictions).
- This means that our model can only **improve** over the null model if the resulting **specificity** is **> 95%**
- And any prediction of positives will **improve** the **sensitivity**.
- This is not ideal. One solution is to **sub-sample to balance the data**.
- For example, if the data has 10,000 observations with only 5% (500) positives, draw a **sub-sample** that contains **ALL positives** (i.e., 500) and a **random sub-sample** of an equal number of negatives (500) and use this sub-sample to train your model.
- See: [PAML4M_9R_ClassificationModels.Qmd](#) → Unbalanced Outcome Variables



How do we Select λ ?

- Classification models are based on probability
- You can vary the classification threshold $\text{prob} > \lambda$ (e.g., 0.5) and get different results → a tuning parameter
- So, what is the best value of λ ? → It's a tradeoff !!
- The specific λ to select within that model to select depends on the analysis goals → True Positives or True Negatives?



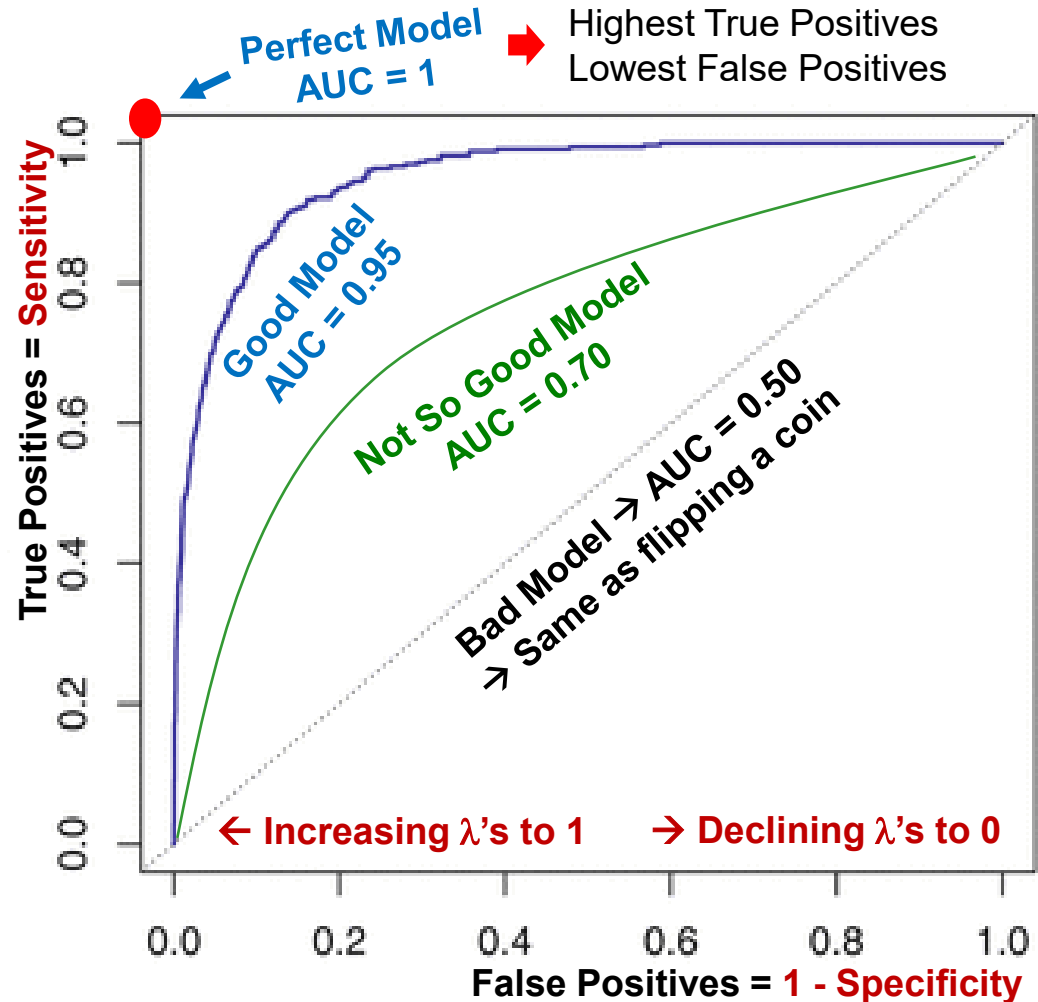
λ , Sensitivity, Specificity and ROC

- As the classification threshold λ changes, **sensitivity** and **specificity** move in opposite directions
- $\lambda \uparrow \rightarrow$ **Sensitivity** $\downarrow$; **Specificity** $\uparrow$; **1- Specificity** $\downarrow$
- You need to try **several** values of λ from 0 to 1 and compare the resulting **Sensitivity** and **Specificity** values
- Naturally, a model that provides **large values** of both, **Sensitivity** and **Specificity** at various values of λ is the **best model** because it provides more accurate classification, overall
- **Receiver Operating Characteristics (ROC)** curve helps **visualize** this tradeoff



ROC (Receiver Operating Characteristics) Curve

- The ROC is a plot constructed by trying several values of λ from 0 to 1 in the model and plotting the resulting Sensitivity (true positives) and 1-Specificity (false positives)
- The larger the “area under the curve” (AUC close to 1) the better the model – i.e., the curve “hugs” the top-left corner.
- The dotted 45° line represents a model that performs no better than chance with AUC = 0.5

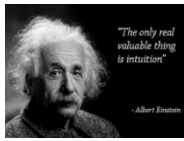




ROC Curve

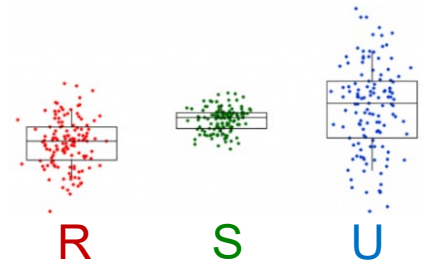
- `{library}` Topic
Search keywords
- The Receiver Operating Characteristics (ROC) Curve
`library(ROCR)`

Multinomial Logistic Models



Multinomial Logistic: Intuition

- In **binomial logit** the response variable has **2 possible values** (e.g., “good mail” and “spam”), so we can easily quantify this variable with 2 binary variables coded **0** (e.g., good mail) or **1** (e.g., spam)
- But if the response variable has **more than 2 categories** we have a **multinomial logistic** situation
- For example, what is the likelihood that a person will buy either a **rural**, **suburban**, or **urban** home?
- We could solve this problem **fitting 2 binomial models** by:
 - ✓ Selecting one home type (e.g., **rural**) as the “**reference**” and code all **rural** home purchases as **0** in **both models**.
 - ✓ Then fitting **two binomial models**, one for **suburban (1) vs. rural (0)** and another for **urban (1) vs. rural (0)**.
- But this is **NOT ideal** because you would end up with **2** separate regression **models** with different fit statistics.
- **Multinomial logistic** regression **fits** multiple binomial models at once in a **single model**, with a single set of fit statistics.



Multinomial Logistic Details

- More generally, a response variable with K categories can be modeled as a multinomial model with $K-1$ response variables and one variable left out (coded as 0) as the reference category.
- That is,
 - The response variable Y has K categories
 - We select one of them as the reference category k_R
 - We estimate logistic coefficients for the other $K-1$ categories
 - In binomial logistic, a coefficient for X_1 represents the increase in log odds of $Y = 1$, relative to $Y = 0$, when X_1 increases by 1 unit.
 - In multinomial logistic, the coefficient for a predictor X_{1k} for the k^{th} category represents the increase in log odds of $Y = k$, relative to $Y = k_R$, when X_1 increases by 1 unit.

Multinomial Logistic Interpretation

Multinomial Logistic Interpretation

For a **multinomial logit** model:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Logit}(Y) = & \beta_{01} + \beta_{11}(X_1) + \beta_{21}(X_2) + \beta_{31}(X_3) + \dots \\ & \beta_{02} + \beta_{12}(X_1) + \beta_{22}(X_2) + \beta_{32}(X_3) + \dots \\ & \dots \\ & \beta_{0K-1} + \beta_{1K-1}(X_1) + \beta_{2K-1}(X_2) + \beta_{3K-1}(X_3) + \dots + \varepsilon \end{aligned}$$

- Y has K categories (e.g., Freshman, Sophomore, Junior, Senior withdrawing from school)
- $\text{Logit}(Y)$ is the **log odds** of the response variable being in category k (e.g., Junior), **relative** to the **reference** category k_R (e.g., Freshman)
- β_{ik} is the **effect** of variable X_i (e.g., GPA) on the log-odds of Y being in category k or $Y = k$ (e.g., Junior), relative to k_R (e.g., Freshman)
- That is, β_{ik} measures how much the log-odds of Y being in category k **change** when X_i (e.g., GPA) goes up by 1 unit, relative to the log-odds of Y being in the reference category k_R (e.g., Freshman).

Multinomial Logistic Regression

- `{library}` Topic
Search keywords
- The Receiver Operating Characteristics (ROC) Curve
`library(VGAM)`



Multinomial Logit: Fit Statistics

- The `vglm()` {VGAM} function in **R** reports the:
 - **Log-Likelihood**
 - **Deviance** (2LL) $\rightarrow -2 * \text{Log Likelihood}$
 - **AIC** $\rightarrow$ calculated by adding $2 * \text{Number of Variables}$

Confusion Matrix:

$$\text{Accuracy Rate} = \frac{\text{Correct}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{\text{Diagonal}}{T}$$

$$\text{Error Rate} = \frac{\text{Incorrect}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{\text{Off - Diagonal}}{T}$$

$$\text{Sensitivity}_{\text{Class}} = \frac{\text{Correct}_{\text{Class}}}{\text{Total}_{\text{Class}}} = \frac{T_A}{A}; \frac{T_B}{B}; \frac{T_C}{C}$$

$$\text{Specificity}_{\text{Class}} = \frac{\text{Correct}_{\text{NotClass}}}{\text{Total}_{\text{NotClass}}} =$$

Pred	Actual			Total
	A	B	C	
A	T_A	$F_{A/B}$	$F_{A/C}$	P_A
B	$F_{B/A}$	T_B	$F_{B/C}$	P_B
C	$F_{C/A}$	$F_{C/B}$	T_C	P_C
Total	A	B	C	T

$$\frac{T_B + TC}{B + C} (\text{for } A); \quad \frac{T_A + TC}{A + C} (\text{for } B); \quad \frac{T_A + TB}{A + B} (\text{for } C)$$



Multinomial to Binomial

The **multinomial** confusion matrix is very difficult to interpret. It is easier to analyze it binomially, **category by category** (i.e., A vs. not A, B vs. Not B, C vs. not C, etc.)



Predicted	Actual		Total
	Not A	A	
Not A	TN_A	FN_A	N_{Pr}
A	FP_A	TP_A	P_{Pr}
Total	N_A	P_A	T



$$\text{Error Rate}_A = \frac{\text{Incorrect}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{FP_A + FN_A}{T}$$

$$\text{Accuracy Rate} = \frac{\text{Correct}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{TP_A + TN_A}{T}$$

Accuracy predicting positives:

$$\text{Sensitivity} = \frac{TP_A}{P_A} = \frac{TP_A}{TP_A + FN_A}$$

Accuracy predicting negatives

$$\text{Specificity} = \frac{TN_A}{N_A} = \frac{TN_A}{TN_A + FP_A}$$

Error predicting positives (**False Positives**)

$$1 - \text{Specificity} = 1 - \frac{TN_A}{TN_A + FP_A} = \frac{FP_A}{N_A}$$



Linear (LDA) & Quadratic (QDA) Discriminant Analysis

[FYI Only]



Bayes Theorem

[FYI Only]

Prior, Posterior and Classification

3 important **Bayesian statistics**, relevant to **LDA** (and **QDA**):

- **Prior Probability:** The **proportion** of **0's** and **1's** in the outcome variable → If we had **no predictors** (i.e., null model), this would be our only reference (*e.g., if on average 5% of patients are diagnosed with heart disease, then in the absence of predictors, your prior probability of having heart disease is 0.05 or 5%*).
- **Posterior Probability:** The probability of being classified as a 0 or a 1, **given** the value of **predictors** (e.g., the probability of having heart disease, given that a person smokes and is over 60 years of age is 0.2 or 20%, this figure is illustrative only)
- **LDA** (and **QDA**) computes a linear (or quadratic) **discriminant function** aimed at providing these **posterior probabilities**, which are much better predictors than prior probabilities.
- **Classification:** is our prediction of whether an observation will be a 0 or a 1, based on the posterior probability. Based on a given **threshold λ** (e.g., prob > 0.5, prob > 0.6, etc.)

Bayes Theorem

Illustration

GPA		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
>= 3.5	1	A	A	A	A	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA
	2	A	A	A	A	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA
< 3.5	3	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
	4	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
	5	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
	6	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
	7	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
	8	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
	9	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
	10	A	A	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA

$$P(A) = 28 / 100 =$$

0.28 Prior

$$P(A | GPA \geq 3.5) = 12 / 20 =$$

0.60 Posterior

$$P(GPA \geq 3.5) = 20 / 100 =$$

0.20 Prior

$$P(GPA \geq 3.5 | A) = 12 / 28 =$$

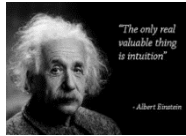
0.43 Posterior

$$P(A) * P(GPA \geq 3.5 | A) =$$

0.12 Bayes

$$P(GPA \geq 3.5) * P(A | GPA \geq 3.5) =$$

0.12



Bayes Theorem: Intuition

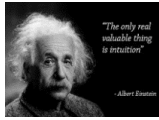
- The Bayes Theorem is **fundamental** in statistics. A lot of what we do in predictive modeling is based on “**Bayesian Statistics**”
- The **math** behind Bayes Theorem is beyond the scope of this class, but it helps to understand **intuitively** what it means
- The **Bayes Theorem** describes the **probability** of an **event** based on given **conditions** (that may be related to the event).
- **Non-Bayesian** – e.g., (**Prior**) probability (make an A in this class)
Bayesian – e.g., (**Posterior**) probability (make an A, given a GPA of 3.5)
- If GPA is **related** to grades, then the **conditional probability** based on **GPA** will be **different** than the **general** probability. In a nutshell, $P(A|B)$ and $P(B|A)$ are conditional probabilities:

$$P(A|B) = \frac{P(B|A) P(A)}{P(B)}$$

E.g., the probability of a student with a GPA>3.5 earning an A in the class is equal to the probability that a student who made an A has a GPA>=3.5, times the probability of anyone making an A, divided by the probability of anyone having a GPA>=3.5

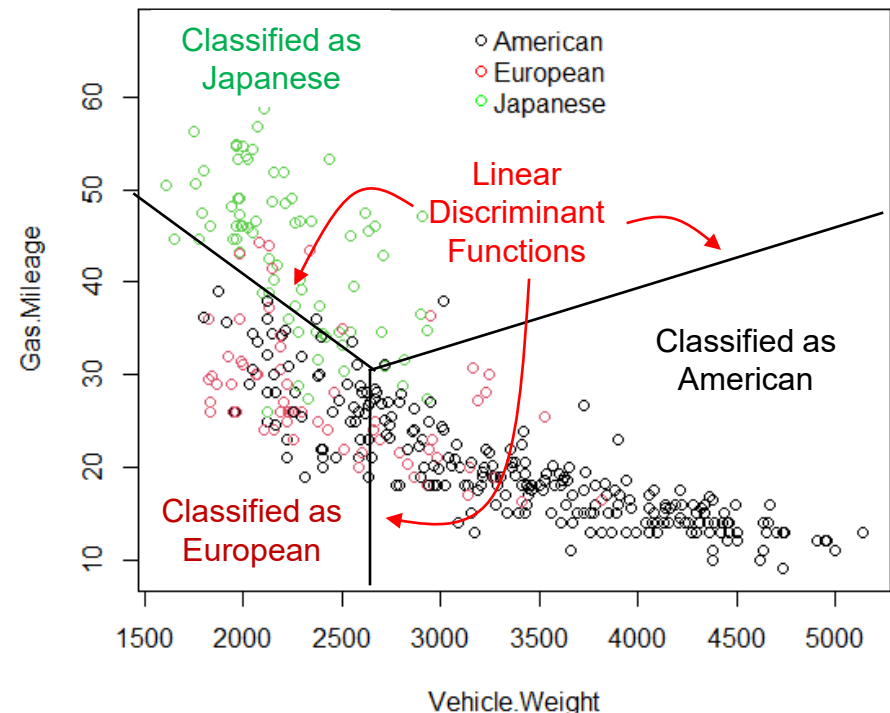
Linear Discriminant Analysis (LDA)

[FYI Only]



LDA: Intuition

- Intuitively, LDA is a **simple concept**, and it can be best explained with a simple example model from the **{ISLR}Auto** data set, predicting the **Origin** of a vehicle, with $K = 3$ (American, European or Japanese) classes and $p = 2$ predictors **Gas Mileage** and **Vehicle Weight**
- We can plot the data for **Gas Mileage** vs. **Vehicle Weight** and **color-code** the dots by **outcome category**
- The idea behind **LDA** is to define **3 lines** (one for each class) and **rotate** them until the **classification accuracy** is maximized
- These lines are called “**Linear Discriminant Functions**”
- It is easy to see visually that if the **classes** are easily **separated** LDA works **well**, but **not** so well if classes are **comingled**.



LDA Explained

- If we know the **prior probability** that $Y = k$ (an outcome is in class k) and we know the distribution of the predictors X , we can estimate the **posterior probability** that $Y = k$ for a given set of X predictors.
- Assuming a **normal distribution** of the X 's, we can use **Bayes Theorem** to calculate the posterior probability
 $P(Y = k \mid X_1 = c_1, X_2 = c_2, \text{etc.})$
- **LDA** estimates K “**Linear Discriminant Functions**”, one for each of the K possible **categories** and **assigns** the observation to the **category k** that has the **highest posterior probability** of being correctly classified
- If there are K outcome **categories**, there are K **discriminant functions**, one for each K
- **Other types** of discriminant analysis use **non-linear** discriminant functions (e.g., quadratic) of the X 's.

LDA vs. Logistic Regression

- LDA accomplishes the **same** results as **Logistic** regression, but through a **probabilistic** method based on **Bayes' Theorem**
- LDA sometimes **outperforms** **Logistic** regression in terms of predictive **accuracy**, particularly when:
 - 1) The outcome is **multinomial** (> 2 categorical outcomes) :
 - 2) The **classifications** for each predictor are **well separated**
 - 3) The predictors are **normally distributed**
- The **tradeoff** is predictive **accuracy** vs. **interpretability** → **Logistic** regression is **better** for inference and interpretation
- Alternative modeling should be tested with **cross-validation**
- In sum, only **use LDA** if:
 - ✓ **Interpretation** and **inference** are **less** important
 - ✓ All **predictor** variables are **continuous** and **normally distributed** → no binary, categorical or discrete predictors
 - ✓ The model has better **predictive accuracy** than **Logistic**
 - ✓ **Otherwise** use **Logistic Regression**



LDA: Fit Statistics

- Like with other classification models, the **confusion matrix** needs to be evaluated to inspect:
 - **Error Rates** – proportion of incorrect classifications
 - **Sensitivity** – proportion of correct positive classifications
 - **Specificity** – proportion of correct negative classifications, or **1-Specificity** – proportion of **False Positives**
 - Depending on the **analysis goals**, we may want to place more emphasis on **one** or the **other** – is it better to send the innocent people to jail or to let the guilty go free?
 - The Bayes classifier uses the **threshold** probability of **50%** to classify an observation into a category, but this threshold can be **changed** depending on the **analysis goals**.
- Varying this **threshold** and **plotting** the resulting **sensitivity** and **specificity** values yields the **ROC** curve (“Receiver Operating Characteristics”) – more on this later.

Linear Discriminant Analysis (LDA)

- `{library}` Topic
Search keywords
- Linear Discriminant Analysis (LDA)
`library(ISLR)`



Tuning LDA

[FYI Only]



Confusion Matrix: Illustration

Example (see textbook): predicting loan defaults with LDA:

$$\text{Error Rate} = \frac{\text{Incorrect}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{23 + 252}{10,000} = 0.028$$

$$\text{Sensitivity} = \frac{\text{Correct Defaults}}{\text{Total Defaults}} = \frac{81}{333} = 0.243$$

$$\text{Specificity} = \frac{\text{Correct NoDefaults}}{\text{Total NoDefaults}} = \frac{9,644}{9,667} = 0.997$$

$$1 - \text{Specificity} = \text{False Positives} = 1 - 0.997 = 0.003$$

Predicted Default	Actual Default		Total
	No	Yes	
No	9,644	252	9,896
Yes	23	81	104
Total	9,667	333	10,000

- Interestingly, this model has a **low error rate** of 2.8%; but we know **a priori** that **3.3%** (333/10,000) of the clients default, so we could predict that **no one** will **default** and be correct **96.7%** of the time → The model is not a big help in this respect.
- Similarly, the models does a **poor job** (worse than flipping a coin) at **predicting actual defaults**
- In contrast, it does a very **nice job** at predicting **no-defaults** (i.e., low positive error)

Tuning LDA: The Threshold λ

- LDA uses a “classifier threshold” $\lambda = \text{Prob}(\text{Default} = \text{Yes}) > 0.5$ by default. So, only loans with more than a 50% chance of defaulting are classified as expected defaults. But what if we change this threshold to a more conservative 20%? See what happens:

$$\text{Error Rate} = \frac{\text{Incorrect}}{\text{Total}} = \frac{253 + 138}{10,000} = 0.039$$

$$\text{Sensitivity} = \frac{\text{Correct Defaults}}{\text{Total Defaults}} = \frac{195}{333} = 0.586$$

$$\text{Specificity} = \frac{\text{Correct NoDefaults}}{\text{Total NoDefaults}} = \frac{9,432}{9,667} = 0.976$$

$$1 - \text{Specificity} = \text{Positive Error} = 1 - 0.976 = 0.024$$

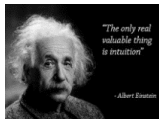
Predicted Default	Actual Default		Total
	No	Yes	
No	9,432	138	9,570
Yes	235	195	430
Total	9,667	333	10,000

- Error Rate ↑; Sensitivity ↑; Specificity ↓
- Importantly, the prediction of defaults has improved from 24.3% to 58.6% (better than flipping a coin)
- Again, tuning the model to our analysis goals is key!! If your business goal is to predict defaults, $\lambda = 0.2$ is better than $\lambda = 0.5$



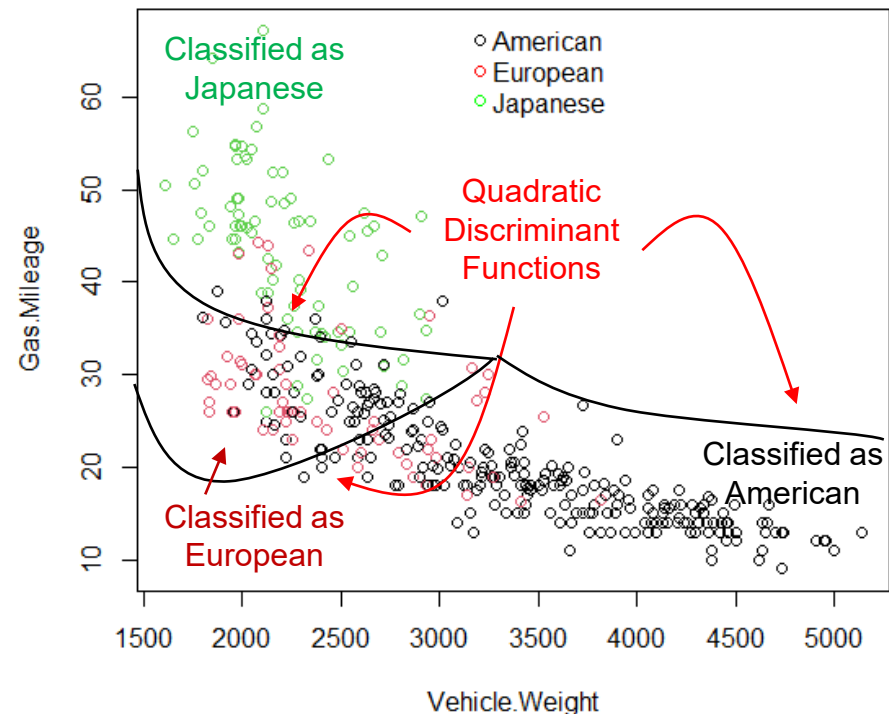
Quadratic Discriminant Analysis (QDA)

[FYI Only]



QDA: Intuition

- QDA is just like LDA, but the discriminant functions are quadratic
- We follow the earlier LDA example predicting the Origin of a vehicle, with $K = 3$ (American, European or Japanese) classes and $p = 2$ predictors Gas Mileage and Vehicle Weight
- The idea behind QDA is to define 3 quadratic curves (one for each class) and move them until the classification accuracy is maximized
- The curves are called “Quadratic Discriminant Functions”
- Which to use, LDA or QDA?
 - Whichever discriminates the outcome in the data, yielding fewer misclassifications
 - As with polynomial regression models QDA has better training fit, more over-fitting problems, and more variance than LDA, but it is a more flexible classifier





Quadratic Discriminant Analysis (QDA)

- `{library} Topic`
Search keywords
- Quadratic Discriminant Analysis (QDA)
`library(MASS)`

Which Classification Model to Use?



Example: Comparing all Models

```
{r}
round(rbind(logit.rates.50, logit.rates.60,
            lda.rates.50, lda.rates.60,
            qda.rates.50, qda.rates.60),
      digits = 3)
```

	Accuracy	Error	Sensitivity	Specificity	False Pos
logit.rates.50	0.698	0.302	0.469	0.822	0.178
logit.rates.60	0.676	0.324	0.327	0.867	0.133
lda.rates.50	0.683	0.317	0.408	0.833	0.167
lda.rates.60	0.676	0.324	0.347	0.856	0.144
qda.rates.50	0.655	0.345	0.429	0.778	0.222
qda.rates.60	0.676	0.324	0.408	0.822	0.178